Speak out

3RD EDITION

B2+
PROGRESS TEST 2 | Version B

Part A • Grammar, Vocabulary and How to …

GRAMMAR

1 Put the words in brackets in the correct order to complete the sentences.

1 _____ (as / look / You / are / though / you) exhausted. Why don't you go back to bed for a bit?
2 _____ (feel / I / getting / I / as / am / if) a cold. I've got a headache and a blocked nose.
3 _____ (looks / though / It / cleaned / as / haven't / they) the flat, but they promised me they would.
4 He took out his wallet _____ (pay / if / to / as) for the meal.
5 She was waving and shouting _____. (though / as / trouble / in)
6 I can't eat meat, _____. (tasty / looks / it / no / matter / how)
7 I'll be waiting outside while you see the doctor, _____. (matter / takes / long / it / how / no)
8 _____. (doesn't / why / It / matter / lied / you) You shouldn't have done it.
9 _____. (that / No / can't / you / matter / dance) The teacher will show you how to do it.
10 _____. (matter / what / No) We'll always love you.

/10

2 Complete the sentences with *should* and the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1 You _____ (eat) so many sweets. They're really bad for your teeth.
2 What are you doing? You _____ (start) a new video game right now. We're about to leave!
3 James was very angry about how you behaved yesterday. You _____ (speak) to him like that.
4 The students _____ (warn) about the test by their teacher last week so hopefully it won't surprise them.
5 If you _____ (hear) of any job vacancies, please let me know.

/5

3 Complete the sentences with the correct continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

1 Maria _____ (talk) to a client at the moment. Can I ask her to call you when she's finished?
2 I _____ (hang around) with my old friends lately. We've all been too busy with other things.
3 When she walked into the house, it was obvious she _____ (repair) her motorbike because she had oil all over her hands.
4 They've lived in so many different countries. I wonder where they _____ (live) in five years' time?
5 He _____ (practise) karate for ten years at the end of this year.

/5

VOCABULARY

4 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 She gave a **pathetic** / **profound** speech which made me think a great deal afterwards.
2 It was **convincing** / **frustrating** that the manager was unavailable because I needed to see her urgently.
3 The amount of information we had to listen to was **fulfilling** / **overwhelming**. I couldn't think clearly.
4 His positive attitude **pushed** / **rubbed** off on the entire team.
5 My mother was **encouraging** / **understanding** when I spoke to her. She wasn't pleased, but she accepted my reasons.

/5

5 Match the sentence beginnings (1–5) with the sentence endings (a–e).

1 I was tearing my hair ___
2 Francesco can be a real ___
3 I had butterflies in ___
4 We were pretty shaken ___
5 Nerea was on cloud ___

a nine when she heard the news.
b my stomach before the interview.
c out when my dog ran away.
d up after the plane journey.
e pain sometimes. Just ignore him.

/5

6 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box. There are three words or phrases you do not need.

abolish	blurred	close-up	eliminate	pose
prohibited	regulate	zoom in		

1 The new banking app will _____ the need to pay with a credit card.
2 Parking is _____ in this area at all times. Any cars parked here will be removed.
3 The authorities need to _____ the amount of water households consume.
4 The picture is too _____ so it's difficult to see the people clearly.
5 He got right near the flower because he wanted to take a _____.

/5

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7 Complete the sentences with words and phrases for advertising and marketing.

1 I hate getting all these advertising **f _ _ _ _ s** through my letterbox. I normally throw them straight in the bin.
2 The advertising campaign went **v _ _ _ l** on social media after it was liked by Harry Styles.
3 We need to do a big advertising **p _ _ h** to make people aware of our brand.
4 This car is clearly a **s _ _ _ _ s** product which makes people feel they've reached a certain level in society.
5 She was wearing a **l _ _ _ _ _ _ _ s** coat which must have cost a fortune.

/5

HOW TO …

8 Complete the sentences with the words and phrases in the box.

disadvantage drove enticed hopeless at logic pressure proficiency question trained unskilled

1 It was her interest in wildlife that _____ her to study biology at university.
2 A: In my opinion, the government should spend more on childcare.
B: I can see the _____ in that.
3 We _____ Heather to come out by offering to get her an ice cream.
4 A: We could take the train when we go on holiday. It's the most environmentally friendly form of transport.
B: One _____ of that would be that we wouldn't have our own means of transport though.
5 Everyone was telling me to take the job, but it was too much _____ for me.
6 My cousin is a(n) _____ pilot and he's been flying for a commercial airline for a long time.
7 It took many years for her to reach such a high level of _____ in nursing.
8 A: How important is it to be motivated in a job?
B: That's an interesting _____.
9 My husband is absolutely _____ taking care of money. He can't do it at all.
10 It can be difficult for _____ workers to find well-paid jobs in my town.

/10

Total: /50

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Part B • Listening and Reading

LISTENING

1 [Audio PT2.01] Listen to five people talking about presentations which they have given. Match the speakers (1–5) with the statements (A–E).

1 Lisa: ___
2 Brian: ___
3 Milly: ___
4 Jack: ___
5 Jodie: ___

A I was pleased with the way the presentation turned out.
B I felt desperate while I was giving the presentation.
C I was afraid of the consequences of my presentation.
D I was amused by what happened during a presentation.
E I was annoyed about my lack of preparation for the presentation.

/5

2 [Audio PT2.01] Listen again. Choose the correct answer (A, B or C).

1 Lisa was
A pressurised to give a presentation to new staff.
B enthusiastic about meeting the new employees.
C convinced she could give a successful presentation.

2 Brian decided to
A encourage the students to work harder by creating a quiz.
B coax the students into creating quizzes for each other.
C stop the class before the students could attempt the quiz.

3 Milly mentions that she
A wanted to give her presentation before her friend.
B should have tried harder to stop laughing.
C felt nervous about giving a presentation in class.

4 Jack needed help with his presentation because
A he had been feeling very nervous beforehand.
B he failed to deal with his clients' complaints.
C he got angry with a client during the presentation.

5 Jodie felt nervous
A despite practising the presentation in advance.
B because of some mistakes in her presentation.
C after receiving a round of applause from the managers.

/5

3 [Audio PT2.02] Listen to a talk about advertising in sports. Number the topics (A–E) in the order they are mentioned.

A Advertising adapted to different audiences ___
B Different forms of sports advertising ___
C Undesirable effects of connecting with fans ___
D Realising the potential for advertising in sport ___
E Advertising is not always popular with fans ___

/5

4 [Audio PT2.02] Listen again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Advertisers were not aware of the potential of sports advertising until the 1930s. **T** / **F**
2 Billboards and advertising signs are only a feature of sports events in some parts of the world. **T** / **F**
3 Virtual Replacement Technology allows advertisers to target their advertisements more effectively. **T** / **F**
4 An advertising campaign for a film benefitted from the support of baseball fans. **T** / **F**
5 Advertisers are more inclined to promote good behaviour among fans these days. **T** / **F**

/5

READING

5 Read extracts from six different text types. Match the extracts (A–F) with the genres (1–6).

1 review: ___
2 humorous article: ___
3 social media post: ___
4 research report: ___
5 how-to guide: ___
6 fiction: ___

/6

A
I have seen too many *Hamlet* adaptations to count, yet I needed little coaxing to see the latest offering from the Royal Vic. This tragic tale is considered by many to be Shakespeare's greatest work, so it made my day to hear about the latest offering by director Sheila Owens. Owens' adaptation is set in the 21st century and much of the communication between the characters takes place on social media. While a giant screen allows the audience to view the content of their messages, I do wonder whether there is a place for text messages in a Shakespeare classic. Owens has clearly strived to maintain the tension of the original story, but some of it is lost in the hashtags and abbreviations, which mean little to someone like me.

B
As the curtains lifted, Little Bee stepped out onto the stage, bursting with pride. His tree costume had been put together by Lottie, his loving older sister. Despite being hopeless at sewing, Lottie had managed to create something which could pass for an apple tree. Several branches hung loosely, weighed down by the shiny red apples. A hole in the front of the tree allowed Little Bee to look out, although his vision was somewhat restricted. He could see clearly now the audience in front of him, but he could only guess where his fellow actors were. During rehearsals, Charlie, the other tree, had stood on his left, but Little Bee had a feeling that Charlie wasn't quite where he should be at this moment.

C
You may have noticed that theatre critics tend to use language which is virtually impossible to understand. I recently had to give up reading a review of a play because it made no sense whatsoever. The long words and strange metaphors drove me up the wall. I probably would have needed a PhD in English to get to the end of it. The problem is that critics want to make works of theatre appear more profound than they really are. They could probably make a children's play like *The Gruffalo* sound like *Heart of Darkness*. From my point of view, all you want from a review is a brief summary of the story, whether the play is worth seeing and what snacks are served in the interval. Is that really too much to ask?

D
@laughingcow wants to know 'What's the worst play you've ever seen?' Well, a few years ago, a friend of mine invited me to watch a play called *Behind the Times*. According to the programme, it told the humorous story of a man who was stuck in the past, but, in my opinion, it was the play that was stuck in the past. For one thing, the only actors were men, as if it was something from medieval times. I don't see why a 21st-century play should only have men in it. The other thing was that the jokes were pathetic. I'd heard most of them before and the ones that I hadn't were awful. I couldn't leave because my friend would have thought I was rude, but I was tearing my hair out by the interval. #rubbishplay

E
Despite a difficult couple of years for theatres, audience numbers have been returning to normal levels in recent months. In a survey carried out in July, 22 percent of people stated that they had attended a performance in the last three months. That was a slight decrease in the number of people attending in April, but reflects a general inclination for theatre attendance to drop in the summer months. The survey also reveals new trends such as an increased tendency to buy tickets last-minute and for Sunday performances. The trend for cheaper tickets presumably reflects the lower levels of disposable income available to households in recent months.

F
Once you've written the introduction to your play review, you should write a summary of the plot. This should be an objective description of the main events which gives the reader a clear idea of what the play is about. In this section, you should mention the main characters and briefly describe the world they inhabit. Be careful not to give away too many details, though, as this will spoil the play for your readers. As a rule, you should never include plot twists or the ending in your review.

6 Read the extracts again. In which one (A–F) does the author …

1 describe how someone was unable to see properly during a performance? ___
2 suggest limiting information given about a theatrical production? ___
3 mention being enthusiastic about seeing a theatrical production? ___
4 complain about the way people are represented in a play? ___
5 attempt to explain why people's attitudes to watching plays has changed? ___
6 explain why the technology used in a play may not have been helpful? ___
7 express their frustration about the way people write about the theatre? ___
8 mention the fact that fewer people had been attending theatres until recently? ___
9 describe their desperation at having to sit through a performance? ___

/9

7 Read a blog post about a fashion photography course. Tick the topics (1–5) which are mentioned.

1 The author's interest in urban art before they went to art college. ___
2 The author's involvement in producing an online publication. ___
3 Finding appropriate places for photo shoots. ___
4 The differences between features of smartphone and traditional cameras. ___
5 Different aspects of photographic composition. ___

/5

The fashion photography course

When I was a student at art college, I did a photography project on urban art. At the time, I was into skateboarding, which has a deep connection with urban fashion. Skaters tend to take pride in their clothing, so I started out photographing my skater friends. I hadn't studied photography before and I was hopeless at taking photos with a proper camera so I used my smartphone instead. I wasn't sure whether the quality would be good enough and I was on edge before displaying my photos at college. However, I got loads of positive feedback, which drove me to get more experience in the field.

For the last few months, I've been working on a fashion blog with some other students. They'd been running it for a while and, when they saw my photos, they asked me to join them. We've only got a small budget so the models are people we bump into in the street. We look out for people wearing original clothes and, as well as featuring photographs of them, we find out about their lifestyle and their fashion inspirations. Working on the blog has made me realise that I'd like to build a career in fashion photography, but I'm still quite inexperienced. That's why I jumped at the chance to enrol on an online photography course for smartphone users. I thought it would help me become more competent and improve my career prospects.

The first part of the course was about choosing locations for photo shoots. I was already fairly experienced at that because of the project I'd done at college. I think I've got a good eye for interesting places, like murals and industrial buildings, to use as backgrounds. What I hadn't thought about before, though, was getting permission. Photography may be restricted in some public spaces, like outside schools, and it might even be prohibited. You need to check this first because the authorities can impose heavy fines if you get caught. Similarly, you need to be careful about taking pictures of people. Even if you didn't mean to get someone in the shot, you should get their permission before using it.

I also learnt some really cool tips about the different functions on smartphone cameras. Not having studied photography before, I didn't even know some of the most basic features, such as gridlines. The majority of smartphone cameras have the option to turn on this feature, which divides the screen into nine squares. Doing this allows you to position the subject of your picture in a more visually appealing way. Another useful bit of advice was about using the autofocus function, especially for more dynamic images where your subject is moving. It's almost impossible to focus manually in those situations, but autofocus will do the job for you, allowing you to achieve sharper images.

The final part of the course was about arranging the different parts of your photographs. Although I'd come across some of the concepts before, it was good to go over them again and learn some new techniques as well. In fact, one of them even broke the rules I'd been taught by suggesting placing your subject in the centre of the picture occasionally. I wouldn't do it all the time, but it's nice to push the boundaries every once in a while. Another valuable tip was to make sure your photographs include a visual story to engage the viewer. This can be achieved by having clues in the background, such as a model posing next to a taxi, which might make the viewer wonder where the model is going. In this way, there's a more dynamic interaction between photograph and viewer.

8 Read the blog post again. Choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D).

1 How did the author feel about the photography project she took part in at art college?
- **A** She was proud of the skater photographs she had taken.
- **B** She was pleased that she could learn how to use a proper camera.
- **C** She was disappointed with the response to her photographic display.
- **D** She was inspired to develop new photographic skills and knowledge.

2 What does the author say about the fashion blog she has worked on?
- **A** It was set up by the author and some other students.
- **B** It pays members of the public to model clothing.
- **C** It has motivated her to work in fashion photography.
- **D** It only features photographs of original clothes.

3 What did the author learn in relation to choosing locations for photo shoots?
- **A** You may be punished if you take photographs without asking someone first.
- **B** You may be restricted to taking photographs in public places.
- **C** You should always choose an interesting place for your photo shoots.
- **D** You should never take a photograph of someone before asking for permission.

4 What does the author say about the different camera functions?
- **A** She was already aware of the basic features on a smartphone.
- **B** She had learnt about using gridlines on a previous photography course.
- **C** It can be difficult to get a clear shot when there is a lot of movement.
- **D** It is preferable to focus your camera manually in most situations.

5 How did the author feel about the final part of the course?
- **A** She wishes she had been taught more dynamic techniques.
- **B** She was pleased to review some of the things she already learnt.
- **C** She felt uncomfortable about breaking some of the rules of photography.
- **D** She thought it was a waste of time to include a visual story in a photograph.

/10

Total: /50

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Part C • Speaking and Writing

SPEAKING

1 Listen to your partner talk about their pictures. Ask: For which person do you think reading is more important?

2 Describe and compare the pictures showing people promoting things. How are these people trying to influence other people?





/15

3 Answer your partner's question.

/5

WRITING

4 Put the words in brackets in the correct order to complete the sentences.

1 One _____ (scenes / the / of / disturbing / most) in film history appears in the film *Seven*.
2 Despite the tragic ending, _____ (which / remain / story / a / is / it / will) with the reader for some time.
3 _____ (rebrand / The / be / would / to / aim) the city as the focus of arts and culture in the north of England.
4 The project would take place over a six-month period and _____ (cost / estimated / be / the / is / total / to) €20,000.
5 Although the campaign would offer many benefits to the local community, _____ (opposition / been / expressed / has / some).

/5

5 Read the advertisement and write a book review.

A BOOK WHICH CHANGED MY LIFE

We would like you to write a review of a book which has changed your life. Your review should include:

– background details about the book.
– what happens in the book – without spoilers!
– what's good about the book and what could be improved.
– why the book changed your life and who you would recommend it for.

The best reviews will be published in the next edition of our magazine.

Write 200–260 words.

/15

Total: /40

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